

desktops on separate sides of the cube. On the extreme right lies the button for Spotlight, a new feature of Mac OS X that lets you run searches on the whole system and gets the results lightning fast.

The desktop in itself is the same as that of Windows, except that you can set the wallpapers to auto-rotate, and the icons are on the right of the screen by default. A typical Finder window has two buttons for back and forward, and three buttons for the different views that allow you to “show items in a list, in columns, or as icons.” There is another button that does some miscellaneous tasks.



The three dimensional cube you see when switching users

At the top right is the ubiquitous search bar. The side of the Finder window has a configurable column that hosts shortcuts to the most commonly-visited places on the system. The rest of the window shows all the items in the Finder in the chosen viewing mode. It basically looks like a simplified Explorer window.

The dock might initially be confusing for new users of the OS. It does a lot of things: it serves as a place to store shortcuts to various applications and files for launching them quickly, houses the minimised windows, and is an indicator for what applications are running at any given time. The icons are not static and are sometimes used to display important information. So, for example, the calendaring application's icon displays the date, and a torrent client's icon would display the download/upload speeds. The dock can be set to auto-hide, and magnification can be turned on. When the latter is done, rolling the mouse over the dock makes it bulge and expand so that the icons near the mouse get magnified. This is helpful when the dock is overloaded with items and the icons are tiny. It can be placed on the left, right, or bottom of the screen, where it is by default.